```
$ curl -v http://localhost:8080/index.php
...
< HTTP/1.1 403 Forbidden
< Host: localhost:8080
< Date: Mon, 14 Jul 2025 17:00:54 GMT
< Connection: close
< X-Powered-By: PHP/8.4.6
< Content-type: text/html; charset=UTF-8
<
HTTP Status Code was: 200
But I don't like you so you are forbidden.
```

Notice that the status code was set with `http_response_code(403)` *before* any output was printed. There's a reason for this. When running in a web server SAPI, PHP will send a status line and response headers as soon as a single byte of output is generated. Once the status line and headers are sent, they cannot be modified. Any attempt to set headers or a different status code after the response has begun will emit an error; this is what happens if we try to set a status code once we've begun to emit output bytes:

```
...
print "But I don't like you so you are forbidden.\n";

http_response_code(403);
$ curl -v http://localhost:8080/index.php
< HTTP/1.1 200 OK
< Host: localhost:8080
< Date: Mon, 14 Jul 2025 17:12:16 GMT
< Connection: close
< X-Powered-By: PHP/8.4.6
< Content-type: text/html; charset=UTF-8
<
HTTP Status Code was 200
But I don't like you so you are forbidden.
<br />
<b>Warning</b>:  http_response_code(): Cannot set response code - headers
already sent...
```